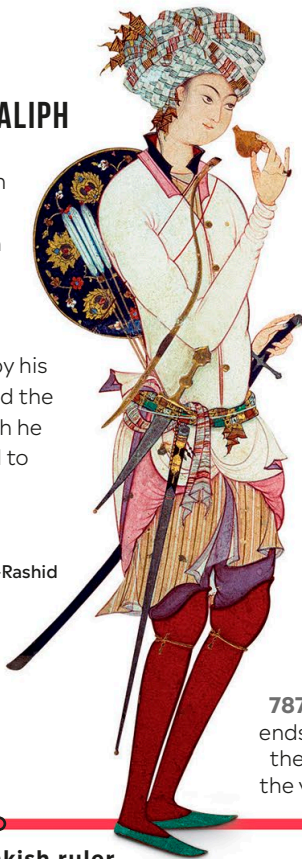


786 CE

HARUN AL-RASHID BECOMES ABBASID CALIPH

Harun's accession on the death of his brother began a golden age for the Abbasid caliphate in which the arts and sciences flourished and embassies were sent as far as Francia and Tang China. Assisted by his viziers, Harun strengthened the caliphal government, which he transferred from Baghdad to Raqqa later in his reign.

▷ Harun al-Rashid



c. 800 CE

BOROBUDUR TEMPLES BUILT

This complex of Buddhist temples was built by the Sailendra rulers of central Java, funded by the wealth of their maritime empire. The largest Buddhist monument in the world, it was built in the form of a three-dimensional mandala that guides pilgrims through three levels symbolizing the soul's journey towards nirvana. It remained an important centre of Buddhist worship until its abandonment in the 11th century.

▷ Borobudur temple

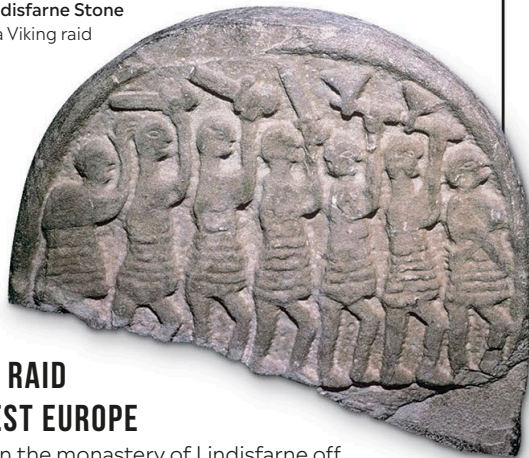


760 CE

787 CE The Council of Nicaea ends the iconoclast controversy in the Byzantine empire by making the veneration of icons legal again

774 CE Frankish ruler Charlemagne conquers the Lombard kingdom of Italy

▷ The Lindisfarne Stone records a Viking raid



793 CE

FIRST VIKING RAID IN NORTH-WEST EUROPE

A Viking attack on the monastery of Lindisfarne off the north-east coast of England marked the start of two centuries in which raiders from Scandinavia preyed on the coastlines of northern Europe. Their longships, which were able to move swiftly and land in shallow waters, and their ability as warriors, helped the Vikings conquer most of Anglo-Saxon England and bring the Frankish kingdoms close to collapse.

794 CE The Japanese imperial capital moves to Heian (modern-day Kyoto)



**c. 747–814 CE
CHARLEMAGNE**

Charlemagne strengthened the Frankish government and legal system, and assumed the title of Emperor of the Romans. He extended Frankish power into Spain, Saxony, Italy, and Central Europe.